



Rise. Register. Grow.

In business, leaders often talk about a "VUCA" world — one defined by Volatility, Uncertainty, Complexity, and Ambiguity (Bennett & Lemoine, 2014). Prices shift overnight, regulations change, and the road to formalising a small food business can feel impossible to predict. That is exactly the world our traders are operating in. So in this VUCA world, we are here to help you VUKA ;-)

Journey 9: Ready for Funding?

This is **Journey 09** of the VUKA curriculum: every journey a food trader needs, from checking whether you're ready to grow, right through to scaling into a bigger business, in one consistent, scenario-driven format.

Each lesson takes 3–7 minutes: a real scenario, a quick explanation, one practical tip, a quick challenge, and a badge.

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Journey 9: Ready for Funding?

"You assumed you couldn't apply for funding because you're not registered with CIPC. Is that actually true?"

Many informal traders assume funding isn't for them. In reality, several South African funders specifically support informal and unregistered micro-enterprises, including street traders and vendors (RegInsights, 2024).

Funding That Doesn't Need CIPC

"You assumed you couldn't apply for funding because you're not registered. Is that actually true?"

The NYDA Grant Programme, run by the National Youth Development Agency, specifically supports businesses operating informally or formally, including street traders and vendors, as long as the business has a profit motive and is commercially capable of success. It's available to youth business owners aged 18 to 35, and you can apply through any NYDA branch, online, or by calling 0800 58 58 58 (Graduates24, n.d.). The SEDFA Township and Rural Entrepreneurship Programme, formed from the merger of SEFA, SEDA, and the CBDA, specifically targets township and rural businesses and supports formalising informal ones (Okhantu, 2025). Stokvels and savings groups aren't a "formal" funder, but they're a trusted, community-based way for many South African traders to access lump sums for stock or equipment without high interest.

 **QUICK TIP** Funders that support informal traders often get fewer applications than you'd expect. Not being registered yet shouldn't stop you from asking.

 **QUICK CHALLENGE** Look up whether NYDA or SEDFA has a branch or contact point near you.

Complete this and earn:  "Funding Aware" badge

Get Funding-Ready Before You Need It

"A funding opportunity opens tomorrow with a two-week deadline. Could you apply in time?"

Start preparing now, before you actually apply. You'll typically need your ID, proof of your trading history (this is exactly why your notebook and bank account matter, they're the proof you can show a funder), a simple description of what the funding will be used for ("a second refrigerator to reduce spoilage," or "a bulk stock discount for the festive season"), and, if it's a loan rather than a grant, a basic idea of how you'll repay it.

 **QUICK TIP** Prepare your documents in one folder, physical or on your phone, before you need them, not while a deadline is ticking.

 **QUICK CHALLENGE** Write a few sentences on what you'd use funding for and how it would grow your income, the start of a simple funding pitch.

Complete this and earn:  "Pitch Ready" badge

Sources for Fact-Checking: Legislation & Regulation

Every legal fact in Journeys 3, 4, and 10 is drawn from current South African legislation and regulator guidance:

- Regulations Governing General Hygiene Requirements for Food Premises (R638 of 2018), under the Foodstuffs, Cosmetics and Disinfectants Act 54 of 1972 — enforced by municipal Environmental Health Departments.
- Regulations Relating to the Labelling and Advertising of Foodstuffs (R146), under the Foodstuffs, Cosmetics and Disinfectants Act 54 of 1972 — Department of Health.
- Businesses Act 71 of 1991 — gov.za.
- Companies Act 71 of 2008 and Companies and Intellectual Property Commission (CIPC) — company registration, business structure conversion, and trade mark registration — cipc.co.za.



- National Regulator for Compulsory Specifications (NRCS), Food and Associated Industries division — canned, smoked, and vacuum-packed products — nrcs.org.za.
- South African Revenue Service (SARS), Small Businesses – Taxpayers, Tax Compliance Status system, and Budget 2026 Frequently Asked Questions (VAT and Turnover Tax threshold changes effective 1 April 2026) — sars.gov.za.
- Unemployment Insurance Act 63 of 2001 and Unemployment Insurance Contributions Act 4 of 2002 — Department of Employment and Labour — labour.gov.za.
- Compensation for Occupational Injuries and Diseases Act 130 of 1993 (COIDA) — Compensation Fund, Department of Employment and Labour — labour.gov.za.
- Basic Conditions of Employment Act 75 of 1997 — Department of Employment and Labour — labour.gov.za.
- National Environmental Management: Waste Act 59 of 2008 and Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) Regulations (Government Notice R.1184, 2020) — Department of Forestry, Fisheries and the Environment — dffe.gov.za.
- Broad-Based Black Economic Empowerment Act 53 of 2003, and the Codes of Good Practice on B-BBEE (Exempted Micro-Enterprise thresholds) — dtic.gov.za.
- Protection of Personal Information Act 4 of 2013 (POPIA) — Information Regulator South Africa — info regulator.org.za.
- Consumer Protection Act 68 of 2008 — online and distance sales provisions — gov.za.
- African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) — South African implementation guidance — dtic.gov.za.

Note: municipal fees, thresholds, and application processes vary by area and are periodically revised by government and regulators. Verify current requirements directly with the relevant municipality or regulator before publishing final figures in the app.

Sources & Further Reading: Business Practice, Marketing & Financial Literacy

Branding and digital marketing facts in Journeys 6 and 7 draw on the following:

- Cloudfusion (2025). 7 Essential Reasons Why Branding Is Important for Business. cloudfusion.co.za.
- Dandu, R. (2015). What Is Branding and Why Is It Important for Your Business? [brandingmag](http://brandingmag.com).
- Mercer, S. (2026). What to Post When You Have Nothing to Post: 10 Content Ideas for Summerville Businesses. What's Up Summerville.
- Why food photography is important for your food business. candyfoxstudio.com.
- Yolisa Motha (2021). A Guide to Branding a Small Business. [ikhokha](http://ikhokha.com).

Statistics on South African small business communication, time management, professionalism, networking, record-keeping, and banking (Journeys 1, 2, 8, and 9) are drawn from national small business research. Verify current figures against original sources before publishing final numbers in the app.

Growth-readiness, lending-risk, funding, and stock-management facts in Journeys 1, 2, 5, and 9 draw on the following:

- National Debt Advisors (2021). Stay away from unregistered money-lenders. nationaldebtadvisors.co.za.
- Startup Mag (2025). Scaling Signals: Ten Signs Your Small Business Is Ready to Grow. startupmag.co.za; Lula (2025). 5 Signs Your Business is Ready for Growth Capital. lula.co.za.
- RegInsights (2024). Small Business Funding. regenesys.net/reginsights.
- Graduates24 (n.d.). NYDA Grant Programme Small Business Funding in South Africa. graduates24.com.
- Okhantu (2025). SEDFA Funding 2026: Requirements, Amounts & How to Apply. okhantu.co.za.
- Ready Accounting (2026). Inventory management tips for cost savings and efficiency. readyaccounting.co.za.
- Xtraspace (2024). Small Business Inventory Management in SA: 10 Top Tips. xtraspace.co.za.

Sources & Further Reading: The VUCA Concept

The mission statement on the cover page draws on the following:

- Bennett, N., & Lemoine, G. J. (2014). What VUCA Really Means for You. *Harvard Business Review*, 92(1/2), 27.

